

Domain: Information and Ideas

Description: Measures comprehension, analysis, and reasoning skills and knowledge as well as the ability to locate, interpret, evaluate, and integrate information and ideas from texts and informational graphics (tables, bar graphs, and line graphs).

Specific Skills Tested:

- **Central Ideas and Details (The Big Picture/Main Idea/Literal Comprehension Same Idea and Different Words)**

Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

Based on the text, what is true about this character?

- **Inferences (Text Completion)**

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- **Command of Evidence**

- **Textual (Support/Undermine/Challenge a claim)**

Which quotation from the text most effectively illustrates the claim?

Which statement would most directly support the researchers' conclusion?

Which statement would most directly undermine/weaken/challenge the researchers' conclusion?

- **Quantitative (Graphic, Graphs and Charts)**

Which choice best describes data from the graph/table that supports the researchers' claim?

Domain: Craft and Structure

Description: Measures the comprehension, vocabulary, analysis, synthesis, and reasoning skills and knowledge needed to understand and use high-utility words and phrases in context, evaluate texts rhetorically, and make connections between topically related texts.

Specific Skills Tested:

- **Words in Context (Vocabulary in Context)**

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?
As used in the text, what does the word x most nearly mean?

- **Text Structure in Purpose (Reading for Function)**

The primary purpose of the passage is to...
Which choice best states the functions of the underlined sentence?
The underlined portion primarily serves to..

- **Cross-Text Connection (Paired Passages)**

These questions require you to compare and contrast two short passages. This is the only question type where you'll see a pair of passages. Some cross-text connections questions will ask you to find a similarity while others will ask you to find a difference. These passages will be accompanied by a question asking about the relationship between them.

Domain: Standard English Conventions

Description: Measures the ability to edit text to conform to core conventions of Standard English sentence structure, usage, and punctuation.

Specific Skills Tested:

- **Boundaries (Punctuation)**

These questions test your knowledge of punctuation and how it can be used to separate or connect clauses. You'll want to make sure you know when to use commas, semicolons, colons, and dashes, as well as when to start a new sentence.

- **Form, Structure, and Sense (Grammar)**

These questions test your grasp of grammar rules. For many reading and writing questions, it's helpful to come up with your own answer before looking at the answer choices. However, for these questions, it's helpful to look at the answer choices first because they will reveal which concept is being tested.

Domain: Expression of Ideas

Description: Measures the ability to revise texts to improve the effectiveness of written expression and to meet specific rhetorical goals.

Specific Skills Tested:

- **Rhetorical Synthesis (Specific Focus “Student Notes”)**

You’ll see a bullet-point list accompanied by a goal. You’ll have to select the choice that “uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish the goal.” Make sure your choice addresses every part of the goal.

- **Comparison and Contrasts**

These questions ask you to identify a statement indicating that two people/things are either similar or different. Depending on the emphasis, correct answers include words such as *like*, *unlike* or *whereas*.

- **Familiar and Unfamiliar**

These questions ask you to identify a statement that would be used to present a person, work of art, event, etc. to an audience that either has or does not have previous knowledge of it.

- **Transitions**

Similar to words and context questions. You’ll need to select the word or phrase that “completes the text with the most logical transition.”